

UNIT 4 CHRISTMAS EVERYWHERE

PUPIL'S BOOK pp. 49-60	FUNCTIONS	GRAMMAR	VOCABULARY	CROSS-CURRICULAR ELEMENT	SUGGESTED LESSON SCHEDULE
Lesson 1 Getting Ready for Christmas	Being able to express the distinction between something happening now or around now vs. usually.	Distinction between present Simple and Present Progressive.	Christmas decorations. Adverbs of time.	Links to different cultures and how they celebrate Christmas. Awareness that children in poorer countries might celebrate Christmas differently.	3 teaching periods 1) A. Lead – In; B. Listening. 2) C. Reading Comprehension Grammar 3) D. Speaking; E. Writing.
Lesson 2 Kostas is in New York for Christmas	Expressing “feelings”. Being able to understand and follow the instructions of recipes.	Verbs expressing feelings usually take Present Simple.	Vocabulary related to cooking special Christmas foods. Vocabulary to express feelings.		3 teaching periods 1) A. Lead-In; B. Listening; C. Reading Comprehension. 2) Grammar Focus; D. Listening; E. Role-Play 3) F. Reading; G. Listening; H. Making
Lesson 3 A Christmas Song	Sing an English Christmas song.		Songs which may present more complex vocabulary.		4 teaching periods 1) Speaking 2) Project 3) B. Portfolio 4) Self-Assessment Test

UNIT 4

CHRISTMAS EVERYWHERE

Cover p. p. 49

Time: 5 mins

Ask pupils how they celebrate Christmas.

- Will any pupils travel for Christmas?
- What are the aspects of Christmas the pupils don't like?
- What do they know about Christmas in other countries?

TAPESCRIPT

Girl 1: I like going skiing! What do you do during your Christmas holidays? (German)

Boy: I enjoy spending Christmas with my family. (Russian)

Girl 2: Christmas is fun at the beach. What do you think? (Australian)

LESSON 1

GETTING READY FOR CHRISTMAS

Aims of the Lesson

- a. to contrast the Simple Present with the Present Progressive
- b. to present Christmas vocabulary

A. LEAD-IN

PB page: 50 / Time: 10 mins

Do/How many children put up Christmas decorations? If so, what decorations?

- What do they think about Christmas trees: plastic or real ones? What are the issues with using real ones?
- Do any of them put lights on their balconies?
- See if the pupils can guess the answers.

KEY 1c, 2d, 3a, 4b.

B. LISTENING

PB page: 50 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

Pre-Listening

- Set the scene by explaining that Susan, an English friend of Nadine's, is in Marseilles, staying with Nadine for Christmas. One can fly to Marseilles or from England take the train via the Channel Tunnel. The trip from London only takes about 6 hours.
- Tell the pupils Nadine and her brother are in the living room. Ask the pupils to predict what they might be doing?

- Introduce the distinction between things which happen regularly and things which are happening now.

TAPESCRIPT

Susan: Good morning, Nadine! Wow, it's late. I was from yesterday's train trip from London. What are you doing?

Nadine: Oh, hi, Susan. I'm making Christmas decorations and my little brother is helping me.

Susan: You're making Christmas decorations! How come?

Nadine: Well, we usually buy them at the stores but this year we are making them ourselves. Come and see... I'm using my mother's biscuit moulds and some clay. After they dry, we spray them with gold, silver and green colour and ...voila! Some of them are ready. Look at the different shapes: angels, bells, trees, balls, stars... Others are already hanging on the Christmas tree. Don't they look great!

Susan: Wow! Yes, they do! It's a very good idea! We usually buy them at the supermarket but they are so expensive! And it is certainly less fun like making them on your own. Can I help you make some more?

Nadine: Sure, join in!

While-Listening.

The pupils need to listen for specific information on what is happening about the decorations this year versus generally.

Post-Listening

Get the pupils to deduce the grammar forms from the verbs in the listening passage. Reiterate the differences between Present Simple and Present Progressive.

KEY 1. ✓, 2. ✓, 3. X, 4. ✓, 5. X.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY A • p. 24

Pupils make sentences with the prompts given. Sample answers p. 126.

C. READING

PB page: 51 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 9

→ Cross-curricular link: SCIENCE.

Pre-Reading

- Introduce the idea of people with Special Needs. Another word is "handicapped"

but that is used less as it has more negative connotations.

- Of Cross-Curricular interest: See if the pupils have heard of the therapeutic powers which animals have on people with special needs. Have they heard of Pet Therapy? You may want to check out the following website:

http://www.holisticonline.com/stress/stress_pet-therapy.htm

- What do the children know about dolphins? Elicit information. "What do you know about dolphins? Where do they live? Are they friendly? Are they intelligent? How do they speak to each other?"
- Ask the children to predict what the passage might be about.

While-Reading

The pupils jot down items in the two columns.

Post-Reading

- What do the pupils think about this? What does this type of therapy do short term? Does it have any long-term benefits?

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY B • p. 24

Pupils write their own letter. Sample answers p. 126.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

PB page: 52 / Time: 10 mins / TB

Introduction p. 12

Explain the structure of the Present Progressive: the verb to be (as it's the present, *am/are/is*) + the *-ing* form of the main verb.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY C • p. 25

KEY

1. During this time Susan usually decorates the Christmas tree but now she is swimming in the sea.
2. Mother usually makes the table but this year she is sunbathing.
3. Father usually carves the turkey but today he's fishing.
4. Felix usually writes Christmas cards but this year he's making sand castles.

D. SPEAKING

PB page: 52 / Time: 10 mins / TB

Introduction p. 11

Pre-Speaking

- Have the children heard about Trafalgar Square in London? One or two may have been there. The tree which is in Trafalgar Square is traditionally a gift from the Queen of Norway to the City of London. Trafalgar Square is where people gather on certain evenings during the Christmas period to listen to Christmas carols. Regent Street is nearby and it has the best Christmas lights in Britain.
- Introduce some of the vocabulary the pupils could be using to describe what Nadine and her family are doing in London.

While-Speaking

Make sure the pupils are using the correct verbs to distinguish between what happens during the year and what is happening now. "During the year Nadine usually watches TV at the weekends. Now she's in London, buying presents with her family. OR Nadine enjoys sowing at weekends but now she's in London visiting interesting places".

Post-Speaking

In pairs, you could follow up by getting the pupils in pairs to ask each other if they are doing anything special this Christmas.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY D • p. 25

KEY First card: b, d; Second card: a, c

E. WRITING

PB page: 53 / Time: 15 mins / TB

Introduction p. 10

Pre-Writing

- Do any of the pupils write postcards when they go on holiday?
- Who do they write them to?
- Ask the pupils what makes writing a postcard different from other forms of writing. The short amount of space limits how much one can say. The messages have to be concise.

While-Writing

Check the pupils are putting meaningful sentences onto the card, and keeping them concise.

Post-Writing

- Read some of the cards out – some of them could be funny!

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY E • p. 26

KEY

He gets the sledge ready
He's putting on his robe
He feeds the reindeer
He's having lunch with the elves
He checks his list
He's watching TV
He helps the elves pack the toys
He's riding his favourite reindeer
He's having breakfast with Mrs. Santa
He's reading a newspaper

LESSON 2

KOSTAS IS IN NEW YORK FOR CHRISTMAS

Aims of the Lesson

- a. to learn vocabulary related to foods.
- b. to learn to use the senses verbs: taste, smell, feel, look.

A. LEAD-IN

PB page: 54 / Time: 10 mins

- Can the pupils name some traditional Christmas dishes in Britain and the States?
- What about traditional Christmas dishes in Greece or other Balkan countries?

B. LISTENING

PB page: 54 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

→ Cross-curricular link: ARTS & CRAFTS.

Pre-Listening

- Have any of the pupils eaten pancakes? Have they eaten crepes? Well, they are similar but pancakes are thicker and served with syrup.
- Teacher can photocopy the page and provide the pupils in pairs with cutout cards for the different parts of the dialogue.

While-Listening

In pairs, pupils order the artwork by numbering them one to six.

KEY The numbers on the photos, clockwise from top left, should be: 3, 6, 4, 5, 1, 2.

TAPESCRIPT

Mary: Let's make some pancakes for breakfast!

John: Great idea! I love pancakes and they're easy to make!!

Kostas: Yum, yum! Me, too!

J: Here's Mum's cookery book.

K: They look great in the photo.

M: I hope they taste as good as they look when we make them!

Mum: Merry Christmas everyone! Mm, it smells delicious in here. What a great surprise, children!!

M: Pass me the syrup, please, Dad.

Dad: Merry Christmas everyone! Oh, Look at Kostas!

K: Yummy! Yummy! We need eggs, butter, flour and milk

J: I've got the flour

M: I've got the eggs, the butter and the milk. I'm mixing the batter. It's looking good!

J: The pan is hot. Let's pour some batter in.

M: Well, is the first pancake ready yet? I'm starving.

M: It's just turning golden.

K: It smells fantastic! I'll set the table.

Post-Listening

- What are the main ingredients to make pancakes: flour, eggs, milk, butter.
- Batter is a liquid mixture with milk, eggs and flour used for cooking, e.g. for pancakes or for frying fish.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 2 • ACTIVITY A • p. 27
Sample answers p. 126.

C. READING

PB p.: 55 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 9

Model answers:

- The photos look fantastic!.
- The pancakes smell good!
- The pancakes taste great!

Differentiated Pedagogy (**):

Give them a photocopy of the following ingredients and ask them to list the steps required to make pancakes.

INGREDIENTS:

- 1 cup all-purpose flour
- 2 tablespoons sugar
- 2 teaspoons baking powder
- ½ teaspoon salt
- 1 large egg, slightly beaten
- milk, just enough to make pourable batter

The process is as follows:

Combine dry ingredients. Stir in egg, and enough milk for batter to pour easily. Mix lightly to blend. Cook pancakes on a hot, well-greased griddle. This recipe for pancakes makes 2 to 3 servings.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 2 • ACTIVITY B • p. 27

KEY

1. Delicious, 2. Happy, 3. Cookery,
4. Fantastic, 5. Tastes, 6. Batter,
7. smell, 8. pancakes, 9. starving

DIFFERENTIATED ACTIVITY B • p. 74

KEY 1. nice, 2. happy, 3. cookery, 4. fantastic, 5. tastes, 6. batter, 7. smell, 8. pancakes, 9. hungry

GRAMMAR FOCUS

PB page: 55 / Time: 10 mins / TB Introduction p. 12

- This is a review of the present simple with a list of adjectives that go well with the verbs which describe the senses.
- Make clear to the pupils: when we use these verbs to indicate how something tastes, smells or feels, we don't use the progressive form. We don't say, "This cake is tasting fantastic!" but "tastes fantastic".

D. LISTENING

PB page: 56 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

Pre-Listening

Imagine the 2 boys are browsing through a general magazine which advertises many different things, incl. cars, videos, foods, etc.

While-Listening

- Pupils listen to the text twice. The first time the pupils just listen. Remind the pupils the boys will be focussing on three items: food, videos and cars. Tell the pupils to focus on

the boys' views on each of these areas.

- During the second listening, pupils must write down only each boy's initials.

TAPESCRIPT

Kostas: Look at this car. It's the new Golf GTI. A great car! I'd like to get that when I grow up. It looks so fast.

John: What about the Audi – that's a fast car as well. I like that - it looks cool.

Kostas: That's too much of a family car – I like it less than the GTI. Look at this pizza. Aren't you hungry?

John: We had pizza last night. Anyway it didn't taste very good – do you remember? What about a hamburger instead. Are you ok with that?

Kostas: Ok fine. What about getting a video to watch while we eat our hamburgers? This looks good! It's the latest Harry Potter. Can we get that?

John: Ok, I'll call dad and tell him to stop by the video store and pick it up on his way home!

Post-Listening

In pairs, pupils check each other's answers with their partners.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 2 • ACTIVITY C • p. 28

KEY Santa, bike, computer, clothes, grandma, glasses, dog, bones, dress, gifts / presents.

E. ROLE PLAY

PB page: 56 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 11

- Set the scene by reminding children that Kostas is in New York staying with his cousin John. Imagine they are in a big department store where there are lots of items which could be given as a present.
- Use role-play cards PB, Appendix, p. 138.
- In pairs, pupils act out the dialogues using the models and prompts given. They can add their own suggestions for prompts.

F. CHRISTMAS AROUND THE WORLD

PB page: 56 / Time: 10 mins / TB Introduction p. 9

→ Cross-curricular link: HISTORY.

KEY 1c, 2b, 3e, 4a, 5d.

G. LISTENING

PB page: 57 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

Pre-Listening

Does everyone know what kourambiedes are? Who makes them in their families? How easy are they to make? Does anyone know the ingredients? Go over the ingredients and pre-teach the vocabulary using drawings on the blackboard.

While-Listening

No writing during the first listening. During the second listening pupils can share understanding and data with their partners.

TAPESCRIPT (with answers in bold)

Kostas: Ok, put the 2 cups of butter and the 1 cup of sugar in the mixer and leave them for sometime until they are fully blended.

John's mother: Shall I add the 3 egg yolks one by one now?

Kostas: Yes but don't rush. Remind me how much flour is needed?

John's mother: Let me see... Oh, it's six cups.

Kostas: You can put it in little by little.

John's mother: What about the chopped almonds. Shall I add them now, too?

Kostas: Yes, and don't forget 2 spoons of vanilla extract.

(after a while)

Kostas: Well, the dough seems all right. We have to shape it into balls.

John's mother: Oh, that will be fun. Can I help out on that as well?

Kostas: Yes. Then put them on this baking tray. Could you please turn on the oven?

(One hour later)

John's mother: They're ready. Now what?

Kostas: Open the bag of icing sugar and pour it here. Roll them in the icing sugar and put them on this platter.

John's mother: They look great and they smell delicious. Shall we try one?

Kostas: That's a good job done together!

Post-Listening

In pairs, pupils check answers with each other.

H. LET'S MAKE KOULOURIA

PB page: 57 / Time: 30 mins / TB

Introduction p. 11

- If possible try and make these at school. If not, still go over the recipe. The children to go over the recipe with their mother's and make the koulouria at home.
- The teacher needs to be very clear on who brings what to schools – and make sure the children bring what they said they would bring!
- Pupils work in small groups. When making the koulouria, it is fine for the children will use L1. When checking ingredients and taking pupils through the process, the teacher can move into L2.
- Have fun!

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 4 • LESSON 2 • ACTIVITY D • p. 29

Mediation activity

Butter: 250 gr

Sugar: Two teacups

Eggs: 6

Milk: One cup

Flour: Half kilo

Cognac: One glass

Baking Powder: 1 teaspoon

Other: Cinnamon, Vanilla extract,

Orange peel

LESSON 3

A CHRISTMAS SONG

Aims of the Lesson

- a. to introduce children to Christmas carols.
- b. to talk about under-privileged people, who will have less at Christmas

A. LET'S SING A SONG

PB page: 58 / Time: 15 mins

→ Cross-curricular link: MUSIC.

- The tune is very catchy and most of you should know it.
- Be open to the pupils asking about one or two unknown words.

PROJECT

PB page: 58 / Time: 20 mins / TB Introduction p. 14

- Christmas Traditions: www.wikipedia.com is always a very good website to find

information like this and they have an extensive site with a very rich list of links.

- In small groups, ask the pupils to put all their work on cardboard and present it to the class.
- Do they know it's Christmas: Set the scene by thinking about countries like some in Africa where people have very little in the way of food, clothing and medicine.
- Get the pupils to work in small groups. To help, try and get the pupils to think of something practical. By giving a small amount of money one can help a huge amount overseas. Are there relief agencies that are guaranteed to invest the money wisely? Think about UNICEF.
- There are charities in Athens and Thessaloniki which distribute food and clothing to refugees within these cities. Do the children know about them?
- One example is on the following website: <http://www.caritas.gr/activities.html>

B. PORTFOLIO

PB page: 58 / Time: 30 mins / TB Introduction p. 14

Pupils work in small groups. There has to be extensive research for the right photos.

If they find photos on Internet, can they be printed out in colour (black and white will be unattractive).

PB Appendix: p. 139

Extra Activity: **"A Letter to Santa"**

- A poem which spares a thought for the under-privileged (see above: 2nd project).
- Each pupil might like to learn off by heart two lines - the whole class can then recite the poem!

CULTURAL CORNER

New Year Traditions (following page)

→ **Cross-curricular link: HISTORY.**

Because the Festive season also includes New Year, the following is a passage that describes the history of New Year and traditions associated with this festivity. You may want to ask the pupils whether they have any other traditions which they know about and which are not mentioned in the passage.

Recommended film see p. 56.

→ **Cross-curricular link: ARTS**

The text describes a film "The Polar Express" recommended for children during the Christmas period. You will find most video shops have this film.

NEW YEAR TRADITIONS

Happy New Year!" That greeting will be said and heard for at least the first couple of weeks, as a new year gets under way. But the day celebrated as New Year's Day was not always January 1st.

1. ANCIENT NEW YEARS

The celebration of the New Year is the oldest of all holidays. It was first observed in ancient Babylon about 4000 years ago. In the years around 2000 BC, the Babylonian New Year began with the first New Moon (actually the first visible crescent) after the Vernal Equinox (first day of spring).

The beginning of spring is a logical time to start a new year. After all, it is the season of rebirth, of planting new crops, and of blossoming. January 1st, on the other hand, has no astronomical nor agricultural significance. It is purely arbitrary.

The Babylonian New Year celebration lasted for eleven days. Each day had its own particular mode of celebration, but it is safe to say that modern New Year's Eve festivities pale in comparison.

The Romans continued to observe the New Year in late March, but their calendar was continually tampered with by various emperors so that the calendar soon came out of synchronization with the sun.

In order to set the calendar right, the Roman senate, in 153 BC, declared January 1st to be the beginning of the new year. But tampering continued until Julius Caesar, in 46 BC, established what has come to be known as the Julian calendar. It again established January 1 as the new year. But in order to synchronize the calendar with the sun, Caesar had to let the previous year drag on for 445 days.

3. NEW YEAR TRADITIONS

Other traditions of the season include the making of New Year's resolutions. That tradition also dates back to the early Babylonians. Popular modern resolutions might include the promise to lose weight or quit smoking. The early Babylonian's most popular resolution was to return borrowed farm equipment.

The tradition of using a baby to signify the new year was begun in Greece around 600 BC. It was their tradition at that time to celebrate their god of wine, Dionysus, by parading a baby in a basket, representing the annual rebirth of that god as the spirit of fertility. Early Egyptians also used a baby as a symbol of rebirth.

Although the early Christians denounced the practice as pagan, the popularity of the baby as a symbol of rebirth forced the Church to re-evaluate its position. The Church finally allowed its members to celebrate the new year with a baby, which was to symbolize the birth of the baby Jesus.

4. FOR LUCK IN THE NEW YEAR

Traditionally, it was thought that one could affect the luck they would have throughout the coming year by what they did or ate on the first day of the year. For that reason, it has become common for folks to celebrate the first few minutes of a brand new year in the company of family and friends. Parties often last into the middle of the night after the ringing in of a new year.



It was once believed that the first visitor on New Year's Day would bring either good luck or bad luck the rest of the year. It was particularly lucky if that visitor happened to be a tall dark-haired man. Traditional New Year foods are also thought to bring luck.

Many cultures believe that anything in the shape of a ring is good luck, because it symbolizes "coming full circle," completing a year's cycle. For that reason, the Dutch believe that eating donuts on New Year's Day will bring good fortune.

Other parts of the world celebrate the new year by consuming black-eyed peas or lentils. These legumes are typically accompanied by either hog jowls or ham. Black-eyed peas and other legumes have been considered good luck in many cultures. The hog, and thus its meat, is considered lucky because it symbolizes prosperity. Cablackboardage is another "good luck" vegetable that is consumed on New Year's Day by many. Cablackboardage leaves are also considered a sign of prosperity, being representative of paper currency. In some regions, rice is a lucky food that is eaten on New Year's Day.

5. AULD LANG SYNE

The song, "Auld Lang Syne," playing in the background, is sung at the stroke of midnight in almost every English-speaking country in the world to bring in the new year. At least partially written by Robert Burns in the 1700's, it was first published in 1796 after Burns' death (see references to Robert Burns in the Cultural Corner of TB Unit 2). Early variations of the song were sung prior to 1700 and inspired Burns to produce the modern rendition. An old Scotch tune, "Auld Lang Syne" literally means "old long ago," or simply, "the good old days".

From: www.wilstar.com



RECOMMENDED FILM

Whether you and your pupils believe or not in Father Christmas, you should all see the following film, which came out in 2004. It is warm, moving and great fun to watch. It makes children wonder about Father Christmas and it makes all adults relive their childhood Christmas days.

The Polar Express

The Plot: Santa Claus does not exist. Or does he? For one doubting boy (voice of Daryl Sabara and Tom Hanks), an astonishing event occurs. Late on Christmas Eve night, he lies in bed hoping to hear the sound of reindeer bells from Santa's sleigh. When to his surprise, a steam engine's roar and whistle can be heard outside his window. The conductor (voice of Tom Hanks) invites him on board to take an extraordinary journey to the North Pole with many other pyjama-clad children. There, he receives an extraordinary gift only those who still believe in Santa can experience.

From: www.IMDB.com

A Viewer Comment: "The Polar Express delivered me all the way back to childhood and my own faith in Santa Claus at the age of five. I could not only hear the bells, I could see his sleigh in the night sky. Chris Van Allsburg is to be commended for writing an excellent fantasy and Tom Hanks for conducting the wonder tour to beat them all. The special effects are just outstanding, the story line credible and heartwarming. The characters are believable and utterly charming. The children depicted are our own. I would recommend this film to any and all who love Christmas and remember what it is to believe. The experience of watching makes you a participant, breathless to see what comes next. I can hardly wait to view it on IMAX and am taking my entire family, including seven grandchildren to the Tulsa Cinemark this season. Let's hope we see more of this quality venue in months and years to come."

Comment made by Mary McReynolds on www.IMDB.com